

INTERNAL



KAYAN
— T2 TO T4 ADVANCEMENT —

Tier Progression SOP

إجراءات الترقى بين الدرجات

Earned not granted; verified not declared

يُكتسب لا يُمنح؛ يُحقَّق لا يُدَّعى

KAY-TLR-003 · Rev 1

CONNECTING EXCELLENCE · EMPOWERING GROWTH

kayanwork.com

EXPERT-REVIEWED CANONICAL DOCUMENT

Batch 12 — Trust Ladder & Talent Registry · Reviewed 31 May 2026 · Reviewer: Claude (expert collective) · Ref: BATCH-12_Trust-Ladder_Review-Memo.md

KAYAN OPERATING SYSTEM

Kayan Innovation, Entrepreneurship & Work Environments LLC

شركة كيان للابتكار وريادة الأعمال وبيئات العمل ذ.م.م

Tier Progression SOP — T2 to T4

T4 إلى T2 إجراءات الترقى — من

Document code	Version	Effective date	Status
KAY-TLR-003	Rev 1	30 June 2026	ACTIVE on signature

Classification: INTERNAL. Document owner: Operations Lead (CEO acting until permanent hire); Compliance Designee on verification. *Connecting Excellence, Empowering Growth!*

1. Status and authority

Canonical within the Operating System. Implements Charter rule C2 (Trust Ladder Integrity). Facts reconcile to KAY-GOV-LF-001; governance to KAY-GOV-002; compliance verification to KAY-COM-003 and KAY-COM-004; QA-related tier signals to KAY-QA-001.

2. Purpose

This SOP states how a verified T2 freelancer advances through T3 (Track Record) to T4 (Excellence). Progression is on demonstrated quality, never on volume, time-in-Ladder, or self-nomination.

3. T2 → T3 advancement

Eligibility: 3+ completed engagements at G9 closure as a deliverer or solo-pair role; 3+ Layer-3 QA passes (no fails); two professional references verified (one from a Kayan engagement); structured T3 interview conducted by the Operations Lead. The structured interview tests: practical capacity ("walk me through a complex engagement you led"); judgement ("a scenario where the SOW criteria became ambiguous mid-delivery — what did you do"); leadership ("how do you brief a junior deliverer on the standard"); compliance ("what is your obligation if you see a Kayan client try to route payment outside the formal channels"). The Operations Lead decides on pass; the CEO is consulted on borderline cases.

4. T3 → T4 advancement

Eligibility: 5+ completed engagements with at least 2 as Pod Lead; 4+ Layer-3 QA passes; peer endorsement from at least one current T4; CEO interview. The CEO interview is conducted by Maher personally and is 60 minutes, covering: depth of subject expertise (substantive grilling on declared SME areas); strategic judgement on a Kayan-scale issue ("how would you structure a Strategic-scope engagement on a new sector for Kayan"); institutional fit ("what does institutional discipline look like in your work"); and intent ("what is your two-year relationship with Kayan as you see it"). Pass advances the freelancer to T4.

5. What T3 and T4 unlock

T3 unlocks: Pod Lead role on Standard and Complex scopes; eligibility to be the Layer-2 reviewer on Pod work; eligibility to be a Layer-3 reviewer for engagements at lower scope; preferential rate negotiation (band 17-22%). T4 unlocks: Strategic Pod Lead role; Layer-3 reviewer at any scope; SME advisor role on Complex and Strategic

engagements; eligibility to be Forge Mentor; preferential rate at upper band (20-22%); peer endorsement weight on T2 → T3 decisions.

6. Tier review (freeze and downgrade)

Two failed Layer-3 reviews in a rolling six months trigger a tier review by the QA Lead with the Operations Lead. Outcomes: continue at current tier with documented coaching action (most common); freeze at current tier pending three further engagements without fail; downgrade by one tier with a re-progression path; remove from Ladder (only for material misconduct, breach, or repeated failure with no path to remedy). Downgrade or removal is appealable to the CEO within ten days.

7. Standing tier review at twelve months

Every freelancer at T3 or above undergoes a standing tier review every twelve months — a calendar event, not triggered by failure. Review covers: engagement portfolio over the year; Layer-3 outcomes; peer endorsement updates; substantive growth in declared areas; AML re-acknowledgement; sanctions re-screening (which happens annually anyway). The standing review is light-touch where there are no concerns; substantive where the year shows mixed signals.

8. Forge graduate pathway to T2

Forge graduates enter at T1 on cohort completion (KAY-FRG-001 §8). The 90-day post-cohort window is the standard path to T2: a graduate completing two successful first engagements with positive Mentor recommendation advances to T2 by Operations Lead decision. Exceptional graduates demonstrating exceptional capacity during the cohort itself may be verified at T2 directly on Trainer + Mentor recommendation, bypassing the standard skills assessment but completing the video interview.

9. Cross-tier discipline

The tier system creates a discipline that is more important than any single tier: every freelancer in the registry has met a documented bar, and every advancement is evidence-backed. This is the foundation of Kayan's institutional claim to institutional buyers.

Authority and change control

Amended only by signed revision against this code, with effective date and Master Review Log entry.

Signatures and authorisation — التوقيعات والاعتماد

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